

EDUCATION

EPFL

Switzerland | Sep 2023 – Present

PHD IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

- Research focus: LLM post-training and test-time scaling for scientific and mathematical discovery
- Advisors: Prof Caglar Gulcehre, Prof Emmanuel Abbe

ETH ZURICH & UNIVERSITY OF ZURICH

Switzerland | Sep 2020 – May 2023

MSc IN NEURAL SYSTEMS AND COMPUTATION

- Focus: Artificial Intelligence, Deep Learning, Computational Neuroscience – GPA 5.8/6.0
- Thesis on meta continual learning under distribution shifts, advised by Dr João Sacramento

UNIVERSITY OF LJUBLJANA

Slovenia | Oct 2017 – Jun 2020

BSc IN ELECTRICAL ENGINEERING

- Focus: Information and Communications Technology – GPA 9.7/10.0, **ranked 1st of 165**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

INHERENT LABORATORIES

United Kingdom | Jun 2026 – Present

Research Fellow

- Long-horizon RL post-training of an AI agent for automated scientific research
- Advisor: Dr Edward Hughes

GOOGLE DEEPMIND

United Kingdom | Aug 2025 – Apr 2026

Student Researcher, AlphaEvolve and AlphaProof Nexus teams

- AI agents for formal proof search in LEAN: resolved open Erdős problems and advanced research mathematics
- Advisor: Dr Francisco J. R. Ruiz

MILA – QUEBEC AI INSTITUTE

Canada | Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

Visiting Student Researcher

- Design factors for training neural networks with GFlowNet objectives
- Advisor: Prof Yoshua Bengio

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

United States | Oct 2022 – Dec 2022

Visiting Student Researcher

- Meta-learning for biomedical zero-shot causal inference: effects of novel drugs and cell perturbations
- Paper at *NeurIPS 2023 (Spotlight)*
- Advisor: Prof Jure Leskovec

IBM RESEARCH ZURICH

Switzerland | Mar 2021 – Jan 2022

Research Intern, Emerging Computing and Circuits Group

- Bio-inspired online learning for artificial spiking neural networks on neuromorphic hardware
- Paper at *IEEE AICAS 2022*
- Advisors: Prof Giacomo Indiveri, Dr Angeliki Pantazi

PUBLICATIONS

Training AI Scientists to Replicate Research

Damon Falck, Samer Sabri, **Anja Surina**, Thom Foster, Anya Sims, Sam Devlin, Dylan Rogers, Tantom Collins, Kaloyan Aleksiev, Louis Kirsch, Edward Hughes

[arXiv 2026](#) 2608.13331

The Future of Facts: Tracing the Factual Generation-Verification Gap

Tim R. Davidson*, **Anja Surina***, Caglar Gulcehre

[NeurIPS 2026](#) Neural Information Processing Systems

[COLM 2026](#) **Oral** Scientific Understanding of Foundation Models Workshop

Advancing Mathematics Research with AI-Driven Formal Proof Search

George Tsoukalas, Anton Kovsharov, Sergey Shirobokov, **Anja Surina**, Moritz Firsching, Gergely Bérczi, Francisco J. R. Ruiz, Arun Suggala, Adam Zsolt Wagner, Eric Wieser, Lei Yu, Aja Huang, Miklós Z. Horváth, Andrew Ferraiuolo, Henryk Michalewski, Edward Lockhart, Codrut Grosu, Thomas Hubert, Matej Balog, Pushmeet Kohli, Swarat Chaudhuri

[arXiv 2026](#) 2605.22763

An Improved Last-Iterate Convergence Rate for Anchored Gradient Descent Ascent

Anja Surina, Arun Suggala, George Tsoukalas, Anton Kovsharov, Sergey Shirobokov, Francisco J. R. Ruiz, Pushmeet Kohli, Swarat Chaudhuri

arXiv 2026 2604.03782 Results incorporated into the Advancing Mathematics Research with AI-Driven Formal Proof Search paper

Algorithm Discovery With LLMs: Evolutionary Search Meets Reinforcement Learning

Anja Surina, Amin Mansouri, Lars Quaedvlieg, Amal Seddas, Maryna Viazovska, Emmanuel Abbe, Caglar Gulcehre

COLM 2025 Conference on Language Modeling

ICLR 2025 Scaling Self-Improving Foundation Models Workshop

The Role of Deep Learning Regularizations on Actors in Offline RL

Denis Tarasov, Anja Surina, Caglar Gulcehre

arXiv 2024 2409.07606

Zero-Shot Causal Learning

Hamed Nilforoshan, Michael Moor, Yusuf Roohani, Yining Chen, Anja Surina, Michihiro Yasunaga, Sara Oblak, Jure Leskovec

NeurIPS 2023 Spotlight Neural Information Processing Systems

Biologically-Inspired Training of Spiking Recurrent Neural Networks with Neuromorphic Hardware

Thomas Bohnstingl, Anja Surina, Maxime Fabre, Yiğit Demirağ, Charlotte Frenkel, Melika Payvand, Giacomo Indiveri, Angeliki Pantazi

AICAS 2022 IEEE International Conference on Artificial Intelligence Circuits and Systems

* equal contribution

AWARDS & HONOURS

Forbes 30 Under 30 Slovenia, Science & Technology category	2025
EPFL EDIC Doctoral Fellowship	2023 – 2024
ASEF Fellowship, funded research visit at Stanford University	2023
Ad Futura Scholarship, for graduate studies abroad	2020 – 2022
Rector’s Honour List of Exceptional Students of the University	2020
Dean’s Award for Excellence upon Graduation	2020
Zois Scholarship, national merit scholarship	2017 – 2020

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, Reinforcement Learning, EPFL	2024, 2025
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OTHER ACTIVITIES

Leadership: Elected President of the Student Council at the Faculty of Electrical Engineering	2019 – 2020
Sports: Bronze medal at the IDO World Dance Championship, multiple national titles	2012 – 2018